CS5224 Cloud Computing: Mock C, Part 1

Mixed, all lectures L01-L10 (the remaining 25 real questions)

Time allowed: 90 minutes	**Total marks:** 31	**Questions:** 25 (19 MCQ + 6 short answer)
Start time: _____	End time: _____	Minutes taken: _____

- **Open book.** Printed or written notes only. No internet, no AI, no electronic devices (same as the exam).
- Questions 1-19 are multiple choice, 1 mark each: fill in **one** bubble on the answer sheet below.
- Questions 20-25 are short answer, 2 marks each: write in the box under the question.
- Tick the **guessed** box beside any MCQ where you were not sure: it helps the review afterwards.
- Do not skip ahead to look at answers. Keep to the time; mark your overrun if you go over.

MCQ answer sheet

1 (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**2** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**3** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐
4 (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**5** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**6** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐
7 (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**8** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**9** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐
10 (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**11** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**12** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐
13 (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**14** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**15** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐
16 (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**17** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐	**18** (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐
19 (a) (b) (c) (d) (e) guessed ☐		

Short-answer marks are written in the boxes. Turn the page to begin.

Section A: Multiple choice (1 mark each)

Question 1 [1 mark]

A company manages development, staging, and production environments using Terraform. Which one of the following approaches best avoids duplication and ensures consistency?

- **(a)** Copy-paste configurations per environment
- **(b)** Use separate state files
- **(c)** Use only one environment
- **(d)** Hardcode environment values
- **(e)** Keep separate code repositories

Question 2 [1 mark]

Your company uses virtual machines (VMs) and is experiencing resource contention (e.g., CPU, memory, disk I/O, or network). Which solution is most effective to address this issue comprehensively?

- **(a)** Add more physical servers
- **(b)** Add more memory
- **(c)** Use faster storage devices
- **(d)** Increase your network speeds
- **(e)** Optimise VM resource allocation

Question 3 [1 mark]

What is a key benefit of using cloud-based databases compared to traditional on-premise non-cloud databases?

- **(a)** Increased security
- **(b)** Lower upfront costs
- **(c)** Increased accessibility and scalability
- **(d)** Cheaper storage
- **(e)** Lower latency

Question 4 [1 mark]

A company, GreatestCloudOfAll Inc, have noticed that their cloud infrastructure frequently scales up and down, which is causing great instability and hence extra costs. You have been called in as an expert to advise them. What would your advice be?

- **(a)** You just need to increase your number of instances and it'll be fine
- **(b)** You can re-check your thresholds for scaling and also add a cooldown period which prevents further scaling during this period
- **(c)** You can monitor it and over time just disable scaling as that will help in the long run in this case
- **(d)** Best is manual scaling, nothing beats it!
- **(e)** Reduce the overall cost by reducing your number of instances

Question 5 [1 mark]

Your company operates a multi-cloud environment (e.g., AWS and Azure) and is experiencing data synchronization issues between the clouds, such as incomplete transfers or data loss. What is the most likely cause?

- **(a)** Slow storage performance on one cloud
- **(b)** Limited virtualisation on one cloud
- **(c)** Incompatible cloud APIs
- **(d)** Uneven resource provisioning (e.g., storage, compute, or network)
- **(e)** Inconsistent security configurations

Question 6 [1 mark]

A company wants to move its deployment to the cloud but is worried about the security threats in the cloud. Which one of the following is the major security threat that the company needs to worry about?

(a) Unauthorized physical access
(b) Data breaches due to multi-tenancy
(c) Outdated antivirus software
(d) Limited user authentication methods
(e) Data leaks due to bad programming practices

Question 7 [1 mark]

You wish to build your own application and are operating in a highly competitive market where being first is more important than being perfect, and rapid iteration is critical. Which cloud service model is most appropriate?

(a) IaaS
(b) FaaS
(c) CaaS
(d) PaaS
(e) SaaS

Question 8 [1 mark]

Your company has built a SaaS that is meant to serve around 5000 customers. However, your SaaS has become very popular (yay!) and suddenly there is a demand from about 25000 users. This will lead to an increase in resource utilisation. What are the incremental maintenance costs (mainly management overheads such as configuring servers, patching, etc.) of adding these new resources?

(a) About the same as before
(b) Twice the original cost
(c) Three times the original cost
(d) Four times the original cost
(e) Five times the original cost

Question 9 [1 mark]

When expecting a huge variation in traffic, as a cloud engineer, we need to be able to ensure the application can scale dynamically based on demand. Which cloud computing service model would we use to implement scalability?

(a) Elastic load balancer
(b) SaaS
(c) Auto-scaling
(d) PaaS
(e) None of the above

Question 10 [1 mark]

Which of the following are signs of a highly available application?

(i) Applications are protected behind multiple layers of security

(ii) Spikes in user demand are met through automatically increasing resources

(iii) A failure in one geographic region will trigger an automatic switch to resources in a different region

(iv) Virtualized hypervisor-driven systems are deployed as mandated by company policy

(v) Application developers ensure the necessary software updates are applied

(a) (i) and (iii)
(b) (ii) and (iv)
(c) Only (v)
(d) (ii) and (iii)
(e) (i) and (v)

Question 11 [1 mark]

What is a primary challenge when migrating legacy on-premise systems to the cloud?

- **(a)** Decreased performance
- **(b)** Increased data compliance
- **(c)** Increased management
- **(d)** Increased costs
- **(e)** Application compatibility

Question 12 [1 mark]

Your company has a policy of encrypting all data that is stored. Your data is hosted in a virtual private cloud and attached to it are multiple storage devices which has the data that must be encrypted. You have the following options available. Based on this, which one of the following options will allow you to do this? (if multiple options are possible choose the one that allows you the most choice)

(i) Ask clients to encrypt their data before they give it to you

(ii) Use third party encryption tools to encrypt the data

(iii) Use native encryption tools available in the Operating System to encrypt the data

(iv) Encrypt your data within the application before storing

- **(a)** (i) or (iii)
- **(b)** Only (iv)
- **(c)** (ii) or (iii) or (iv)
- **(d)** (i) or (ii) or (iii)
- **(e)** (iii) or (iv)

Question 13 [1 mark]

What is the advantage of a single tenancy cloud environment over a multitenancy environment?

- **(a)** Lower costs due to shared resources
- **(b)** Enhanced data security and isolation
- **(c)** Faster scalability for user spikes
- **(d)** Simplified resource management
- **(e)** Reduced need for compliance controls

Question 14 [1 mark]

Your company has recently gotten to grips with Terraform and wish to use it. However, they also wish to have automatic drift detection during continuous integration (the practice of merging code changes into a central repository frequently). Which of the following is the best approach to achieve this?

- **(a)** Run terraform apply daily
- **(b)** Disable drift checks
- **(c)** Use manual audits
- **(d)** Periodically recreate the infrastructure
- **(e)** Run terraform plan and provide an alert on changes

Question 15 [1 mark]

You are part of an e-commerce start-up and wish to understand the shopping patterns arising from last year's sales events. In order to do this, you have been tasked with doing the data analysis where you have a lot of data. Which cloud deployment will you choose as the best option?

- **(a)** Public cloud only
- **(b)** Private cloud only
- **(c)** Hybrid cloud
- **(d)** Either Public or Private cloud
- **(e)** Multi-cloud

Question 16 [1 mark]

Which level of cloud service is usually provided for the application to run the development environment?

(a) PaaS
(b) IaaS
(c) SaaS
(d) FaaS
(e) None of the above

Question 17 [1 mark]

A company wishes to migrate its legacy application to the cloud quickly with minimal changes. Which approach from the following would be most suited (you can assume that all options listed are technically feasible)?

(a) Refactor the application to use serverless functions and then deploy it
(b) Get a cloud provider to build a SaaS equivalent solution for you and then use it
(c) Rewrite the application using a PaaS platform which allows for easy deployment
(d) Use IaaS and move application as is from on-premise to cloud
(e) Keep it on-premise

Question 18 [1 mark]

You are the founder of a start-up with very limited personnel. Your company handles the input and processing of infectious disease clinical trial data on the cloud. The data processing needs to be real-time. The data contain highly sensitive, personally identifiable information. However, you want to reduce as much manual work as you can due to your small team. Which service should you choose for this application?

(a) IaaS
(b) FaaS
(c) CaaS
(d) PaaS
(e) SaaS

Question 19 [1 mark]

Which one of the following statements is NOT true about Cloud Computing?

(a) Opex includes expenses like electricity and maintenance for on-premise IT resources
(b) Detecting spam in social media is a good example of a use case for MapReduce
(c) PaaS is the cloud service that is usually provided to run the development environment
(d) Elastic scaling can dynamically increase or decrease server resources based on a specific period
(e) Higher security threats are a disadvantage of using public PaaS for SaaS development

Section B: Short answer (2 marks each)

Question 20 [2 marks]

You are a Solutions Architect at a leading technology company. The IT division of the metropolitan MRT (Mass Rapid Transit) system has approached you to design a next-generation payment platform to support SimplyGo and phase out the legacy EZ-Link card system. A key concern is that during peak hours, the current system experiences high latency, resulting in long queues and poor commuter experience. The reason for this is that for each user, the system performs fare calculation, balance deduction, and displays the update immediately before letting the user pass through the gate.

Your task is to propose two ways in which this payment platform can be scalable and also have low-latency.

Question 21 [2 marks]

The company you work for is responsible for a large web server farm. You are tasked with increasing the availability of this farm to ensure little to no downtime. List two ways in which you can achieve this.

Question 22 [2 marks]

It is the upcoming holiday season and your application has gained a lot of traction. However, the downside is that your cloud infrastructure is struggling with this load. You have looked into auto-scaling and load-balancing already. List two other methods that you can use to help with this issue.

Question 23 [2 marks]

Your workplace wishes to make the work environment a bit more fun. They are going to provide advanced collaboration services, such as video, chat, and an online whiteboard. Given the cost of hosting the infrastructure for this, they have decided that a cloud-based approach is the way to go. Which cloud computing deployment model would best suit your company's needs? Explain your answer.

Question 24 [2 marks]

Assume that you are responsible for organising your cloud resources globally as the leader of an enterprise. Discuss at least two key factors that you should consider when deciding on cloud resource hosting.

Question 25 [2 marks]

You are a cloud developer who is deploying your application (which has a steady-state workload) to AWS. Which pricing option would you choose and why?